

EMERGENCY ACTION PLAN — DO THIS TODAY

For: John Doe

Your deadline is shown on your summons. Do not wait.

IMMEDIATELY — Next 24 Hours

Find your eviction summons. Look for the DEADLINE DATE and CASE NUMBER.

Write the deadline on your calendar. Set a phone alarm 2 days BEFORE it.

Read this entire packet. You will need to understand every document.

If you can, call a friend or family member. You do not have to do this alone.

NEXT — Within 1-2 Days

Fill out and SIGN your Answer form (separate PDF). Use blue or black ink.

Complete your fee waiver form if you cannot afford the filing fee.

Make 3 copies of EVERYTHING. The court clerk keeps the original.

FILE — Before Your Deadline

Go to the courthouse in person OR e-file online (see E-Filing Instructions).

Bring: signed Answer form, fee waiver form, copies of everything, photo ID.

Ask the clerk to stamp your copies as FILED. Keep one for yourself.

If filing by mail, use certified mail with return receipt.

AFTER FILING — Serve the Landlord

Deliver a filed copy to your landlord or their attorney.

Do this by certified mail, hand delivery, or email (with read receipt).

Keep PROOF — mail receipt, delivery confirmation, or email screenshot.

PREPARE FOR COURT

Read the Defenses Explained document to understand your legal options.

Read the Evidence Guide and start gathering evidence TODAY.

Review the Hearing Script. Practice saying it out loud.

Call the rental assistance numbers in this packet. Apply for help immediately.

IF YOU MISS YOUR DEADLINE: The judge may enter a default judgment against you and you could be evicted without a hearing. **THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT THING.** File your answer on time.